

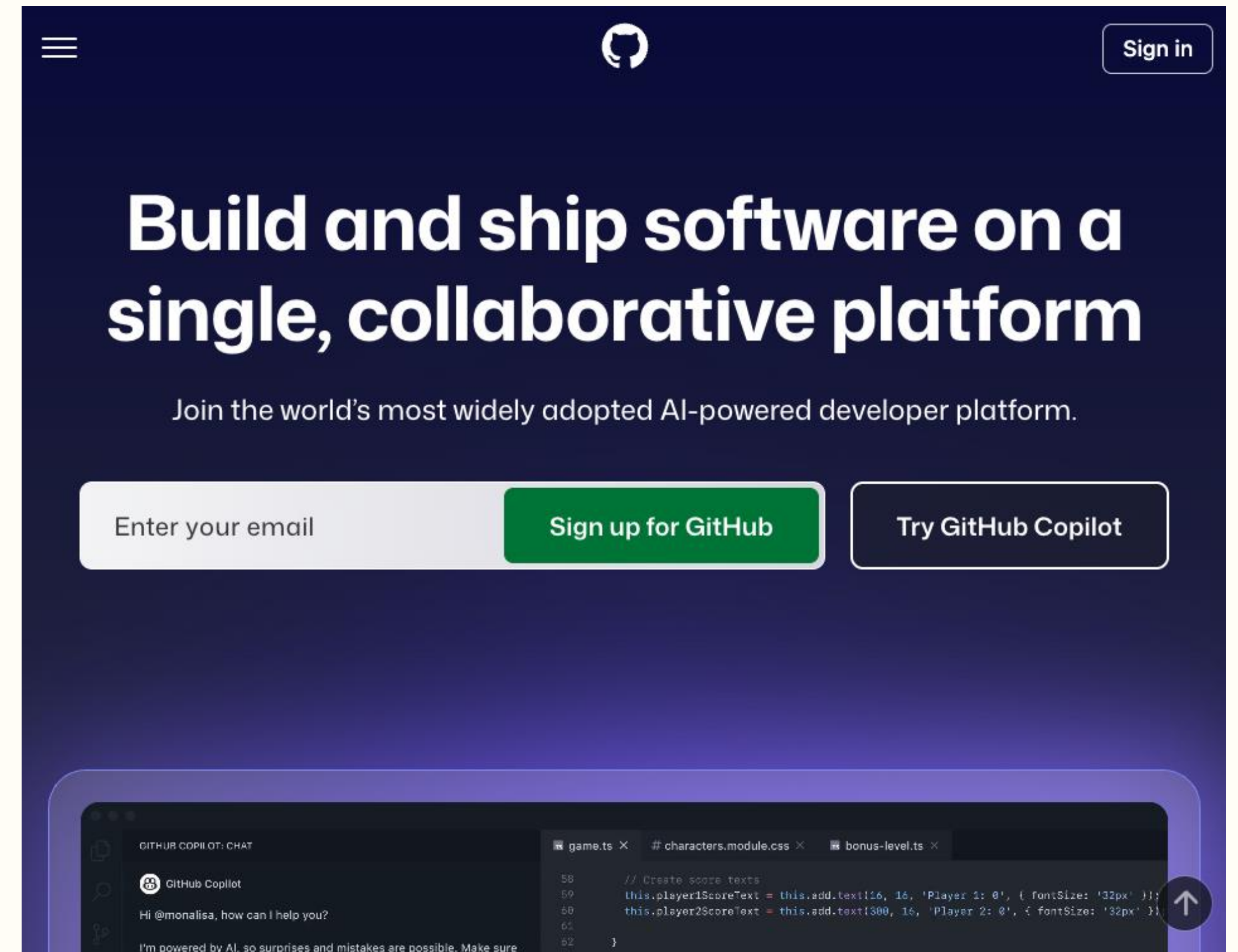
Introduction to GitHub

Heather Mattie, PhD

GitHub

GitHub is a cloud-based platform for software developers and others to build, store, manage, and share code and projects using Git's version control system. It acts as a central hub for collaboration, allowing teams to

- Track changes
- Work on separate versions at the same time
- Suggest and review contributions
- Manage project tasks



GitHub

What will we use GitHub for?

- All course materials

coredatascience / BST219_2026

Code

Issues

Pull requests

Agents

Actions

Projects

Wiki

Security and quality

Insights

Settings

Search

Type to search

BST219_2026

Public

Edit Pins

Watch 0

Fork 0

Star 2

main

1 Branch

0 Tags

Go to file

T

Add file

Code

h

hmattie

Add files via upload

bb3608b · 5 days ago

11 Commits

00_course_introduction	Add files via upload	last week
01_GitHub	Add files via upload	last week
02_R_basics	Add files via upload	last week
Lecture_slides	Add files via upload	5 days ago
LICENSE	Initial commit	last month
README.md	Revise office hours and course material folder names	last week

README

MIT license

✎

☰

Welcome to BST 219: Core Principles of Data Science!

- Course materials for Fall 2026 can be found here.

About

Fall 2026 Companion GitHub repository for BST 219: Core Principles of Data Science at the Harvard TH Chan School of Public Health.

Readme

MIT license

Activity

Custom properties

2 stars

0 watching

0 forks

Audit log

Report repository

Releases

No releases published

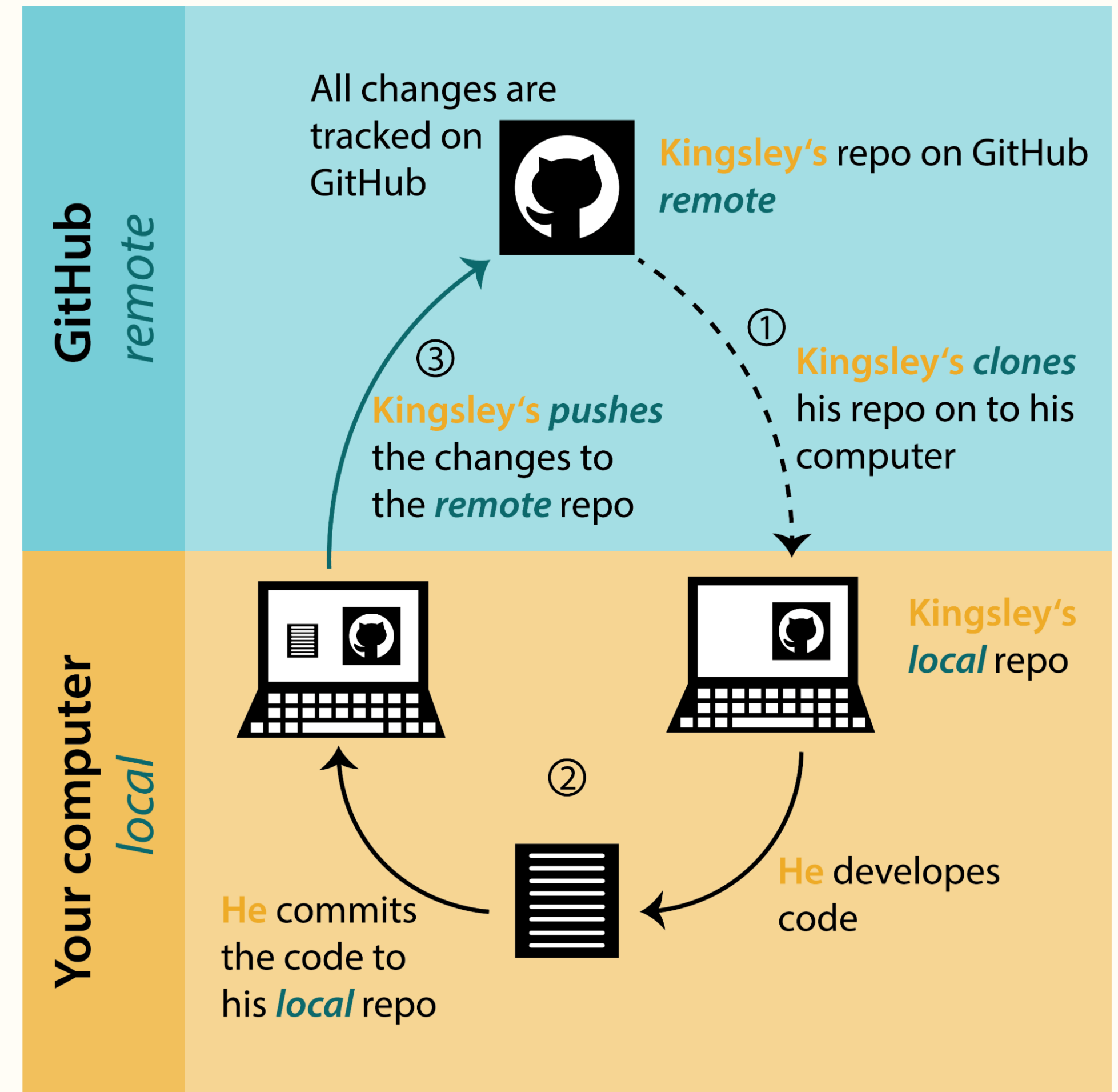
Create a new release



GitHub

The main reasons to use GitHub

- Version control so you don't lose any work
- Always good to try a tool commonly used in data science



GitHub

- GitHub has specific terminology it would be useful to remember.
- Different commands are used for different steps of the version control process. We will only be using a few of them in this course.

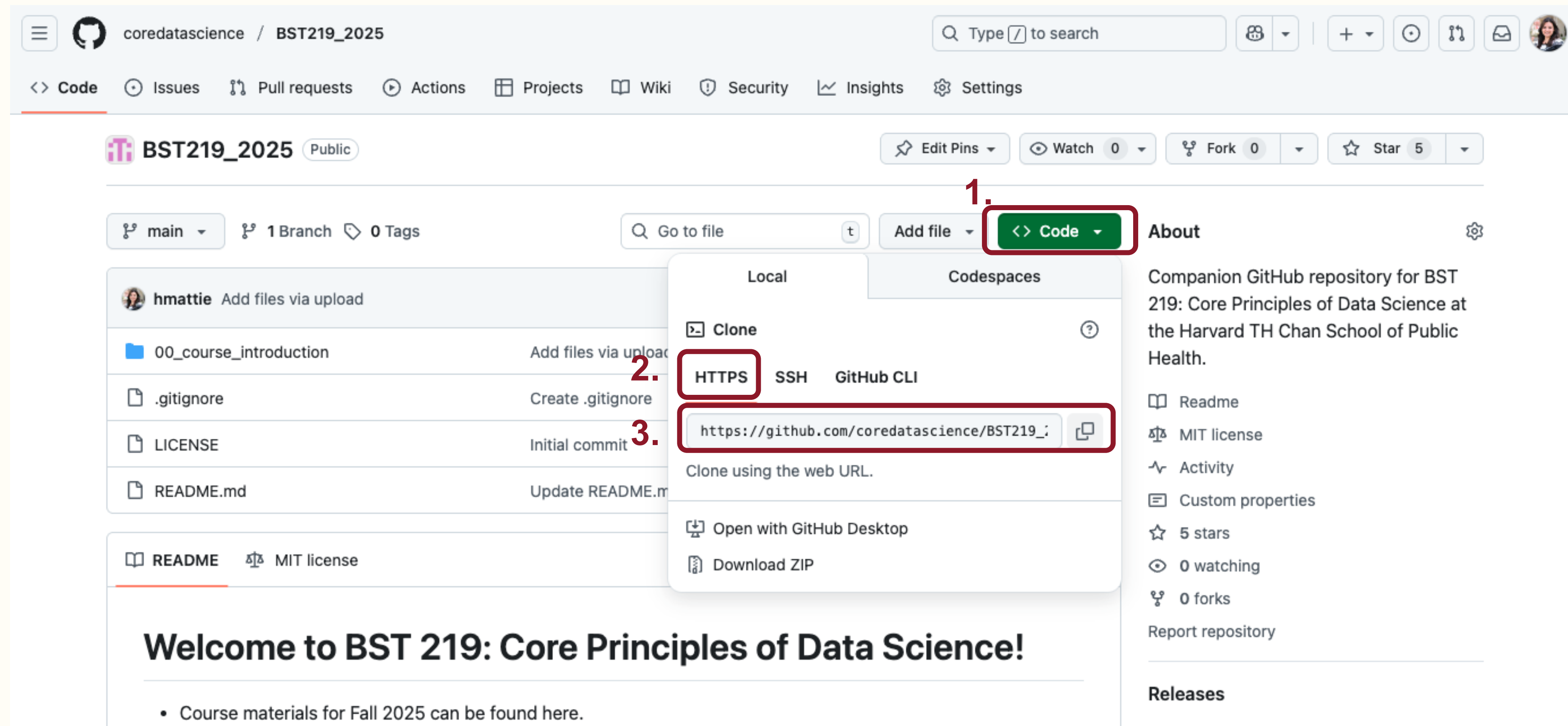
Definitions

- **repo** - short for repository
- **repository** - the directory or folder that is under version control
- **local** - the repository on your computer
- **remote** - the repository on GitHub
- **commit** - take a snapshot of one or more files in the repository
- **push** - send commits from the local repo to the remote repo
- **pull** - retrieve commits from the remote repo to the local repo
- **.gitignore** a file that tells git which files or types of files you don't want to commit

Accessing GitHub in RStudio

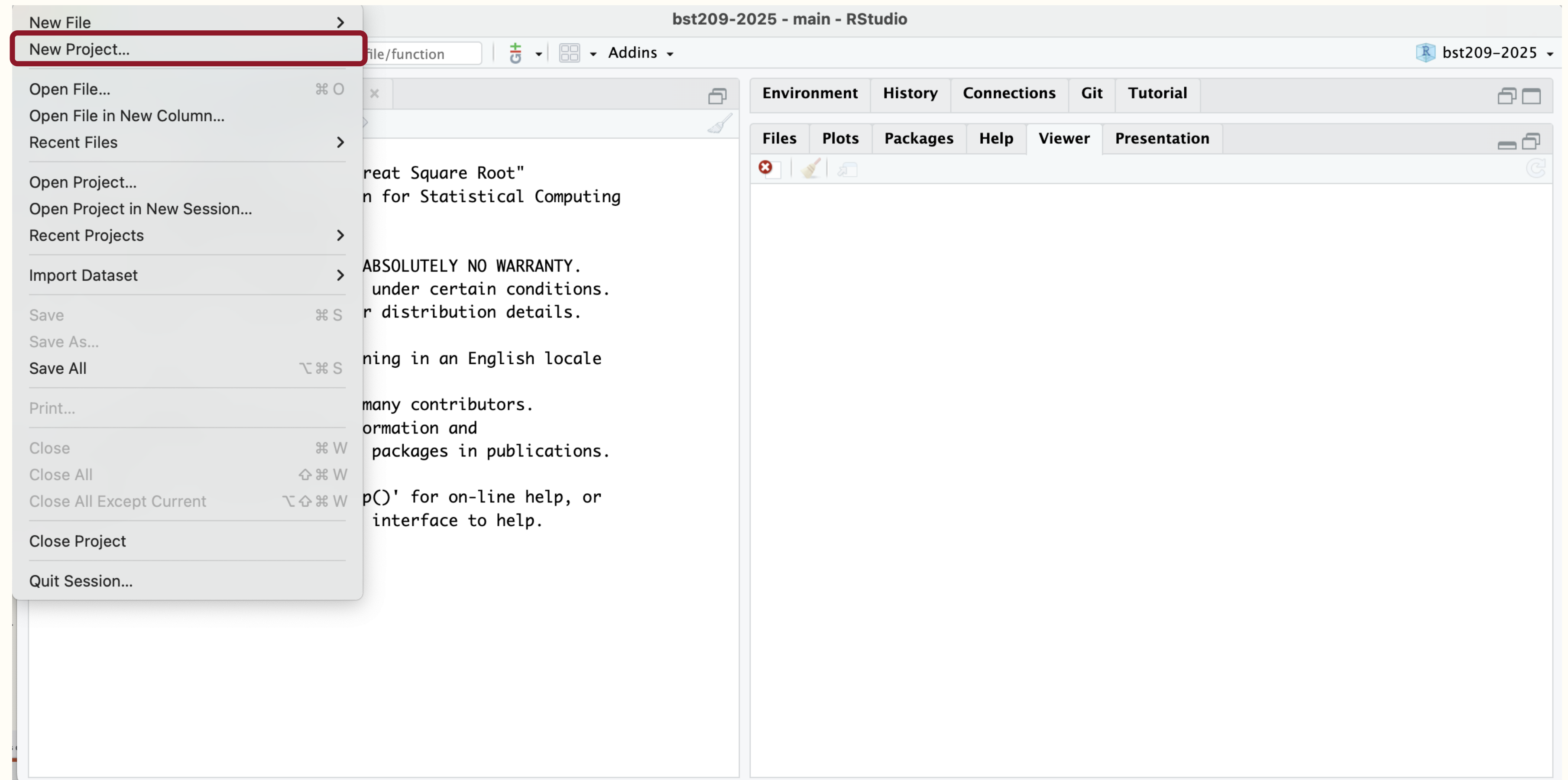
We won't be using the Terminal or Command Line to work with GitHub - we'll be working inside RStudio.

Step 1: Clone the repository



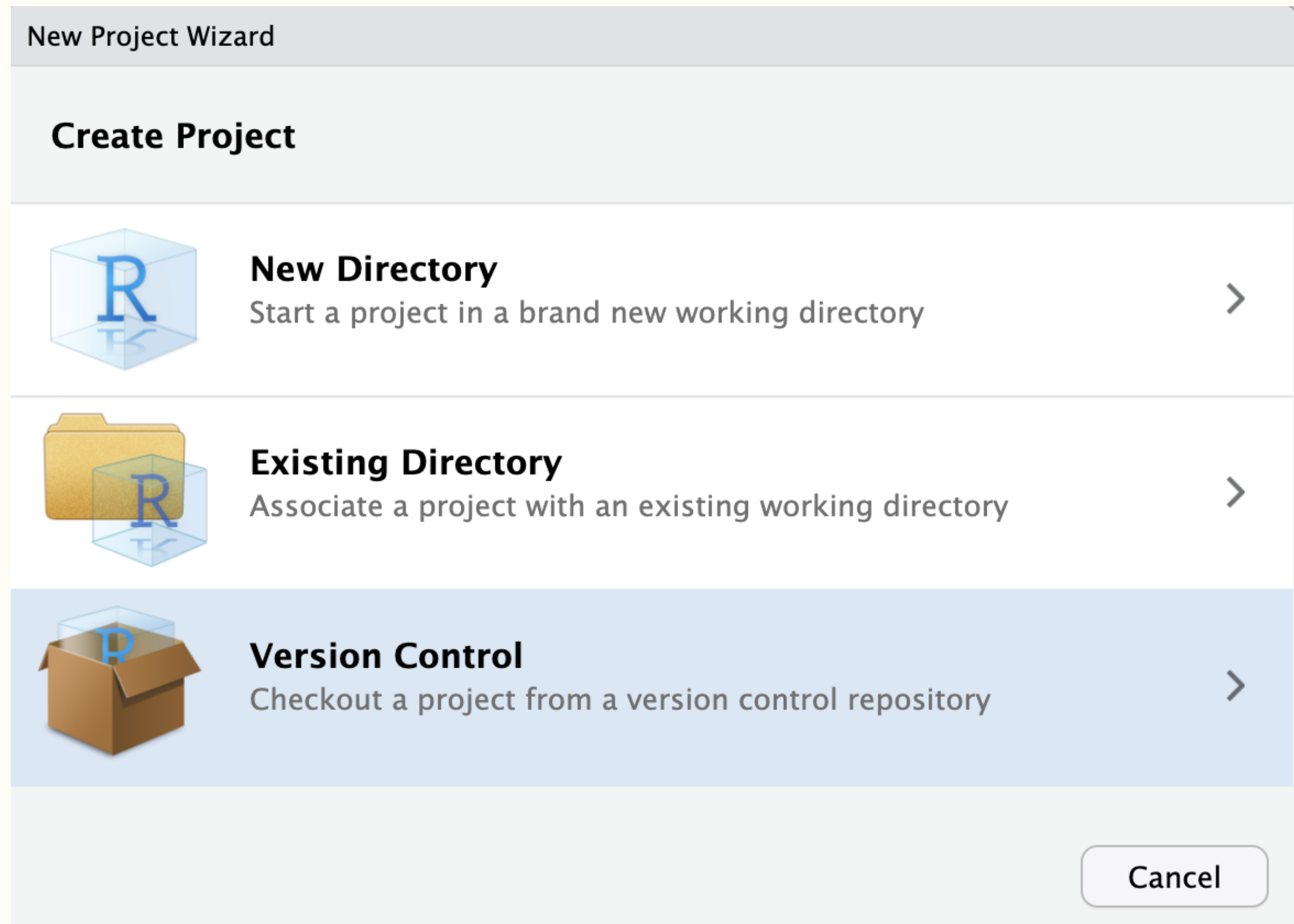
Accessing GitHub in RStudio

Step 2: Open RStudio and select New Project



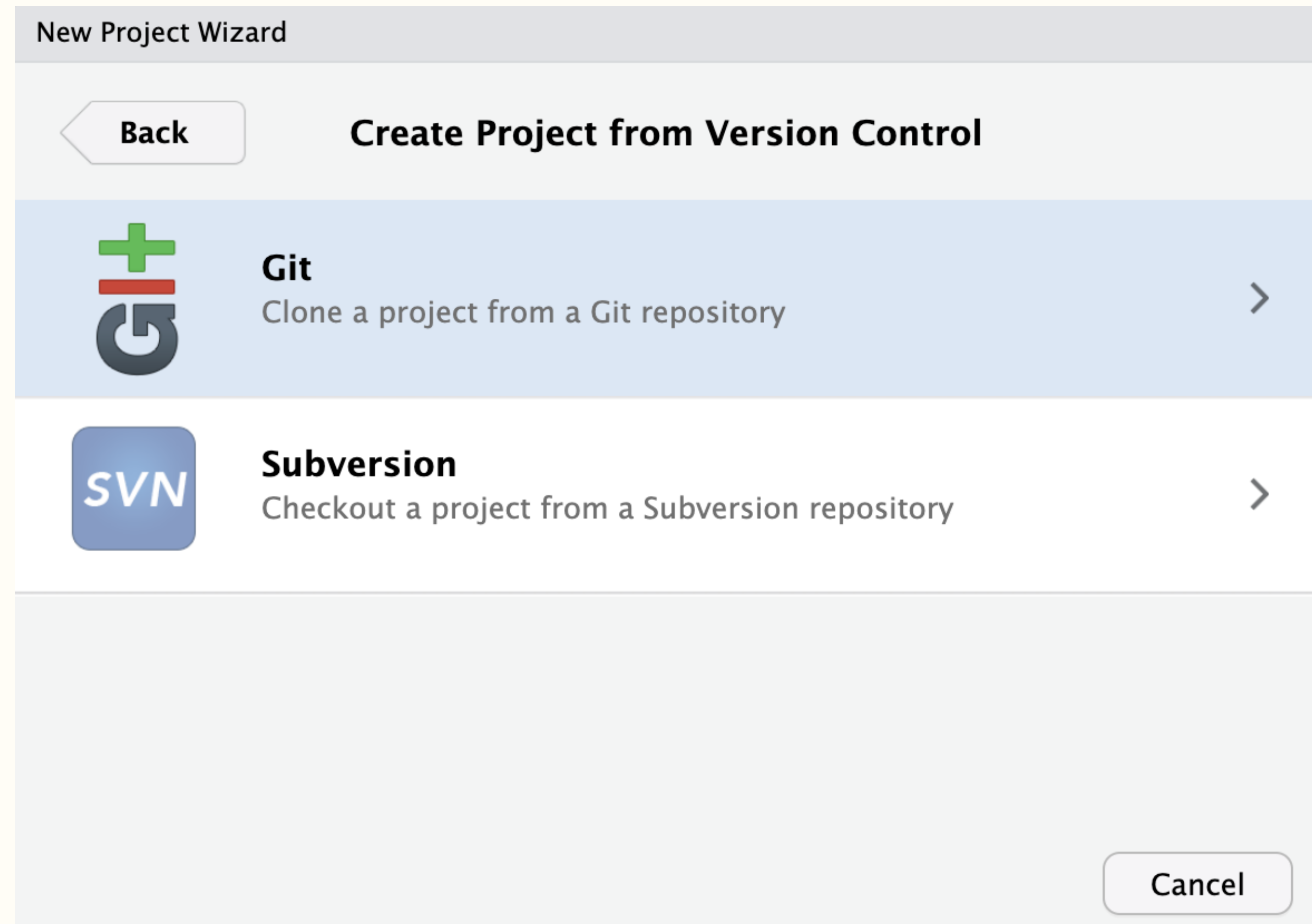
Accessing GitHub in RStudio

Step 3: Select Version Control



Accessing GitHub in RStudio

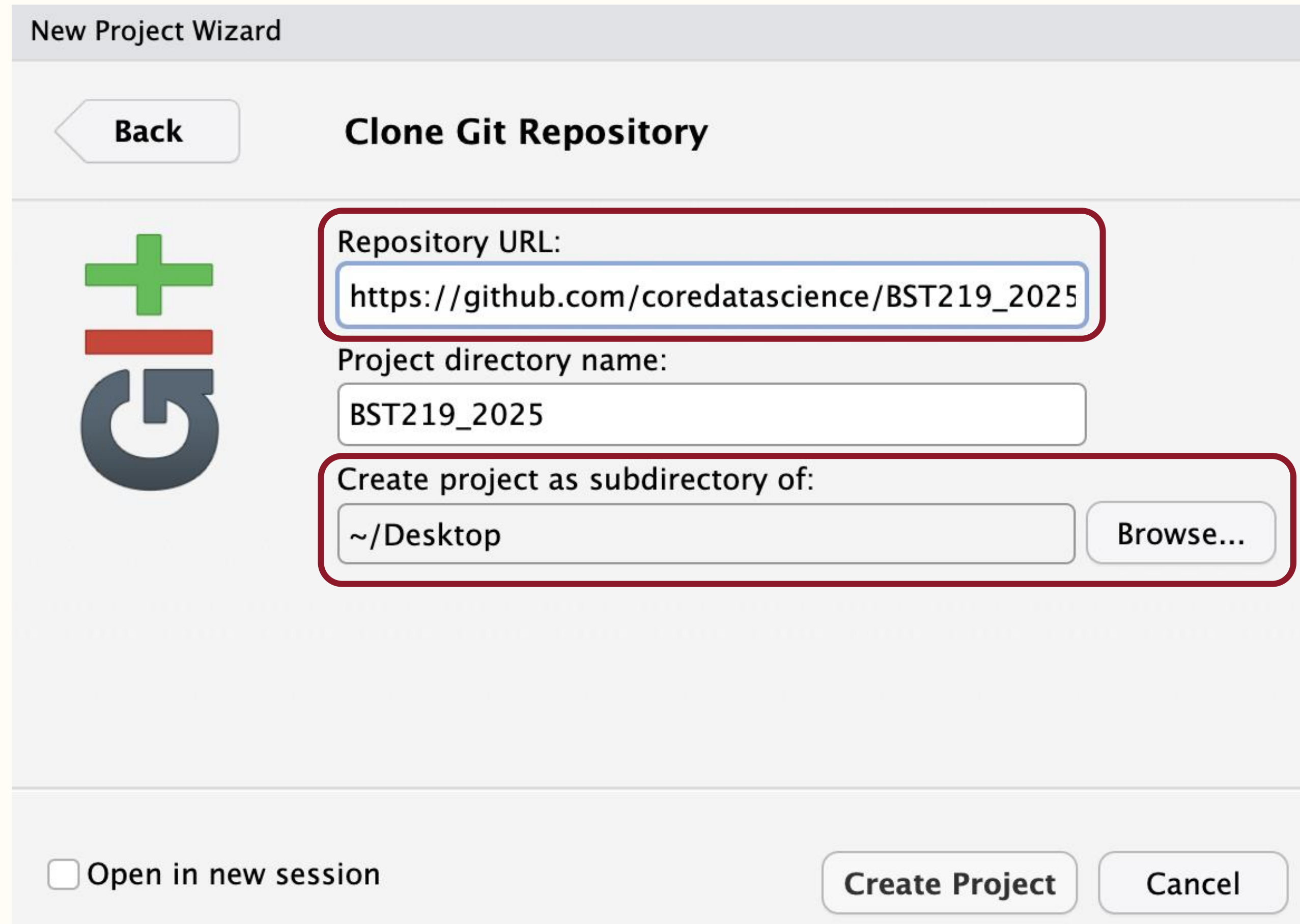
Step 4: Select Git



Accessing GitHub in RStudio

Step 5: Paste the repository link you copied on GitHub

This will become a folder on your computer - take note of where you are saving it!



The screenshot shows the 'New Project Wizard' dialog box in RStudio, specifically the 'Clone Git Repository' step. The dialog has a title bar 'New Project Wizard' and a 'Back' button. On the left is a large green plus sign over a grey 'G' logo. The main area contains three input fields: 'Repository URL:' with the value 'https://github.com/coredatascience/BST219_2025', 'Project directory name:' with the value 'BST219_2025', and 'Create project as subdirectory of:' with the value '~/Desktop'. A 'Browse...' button is next to the last field. At the bottom, there is a checkbox 'Open in new session' and two buttons: 'Create Project' and 'Cancel'.

New Project Wizard

Back Clone Git Repository

Repository URL:
https://github.com/coredatascience/BST219_2025

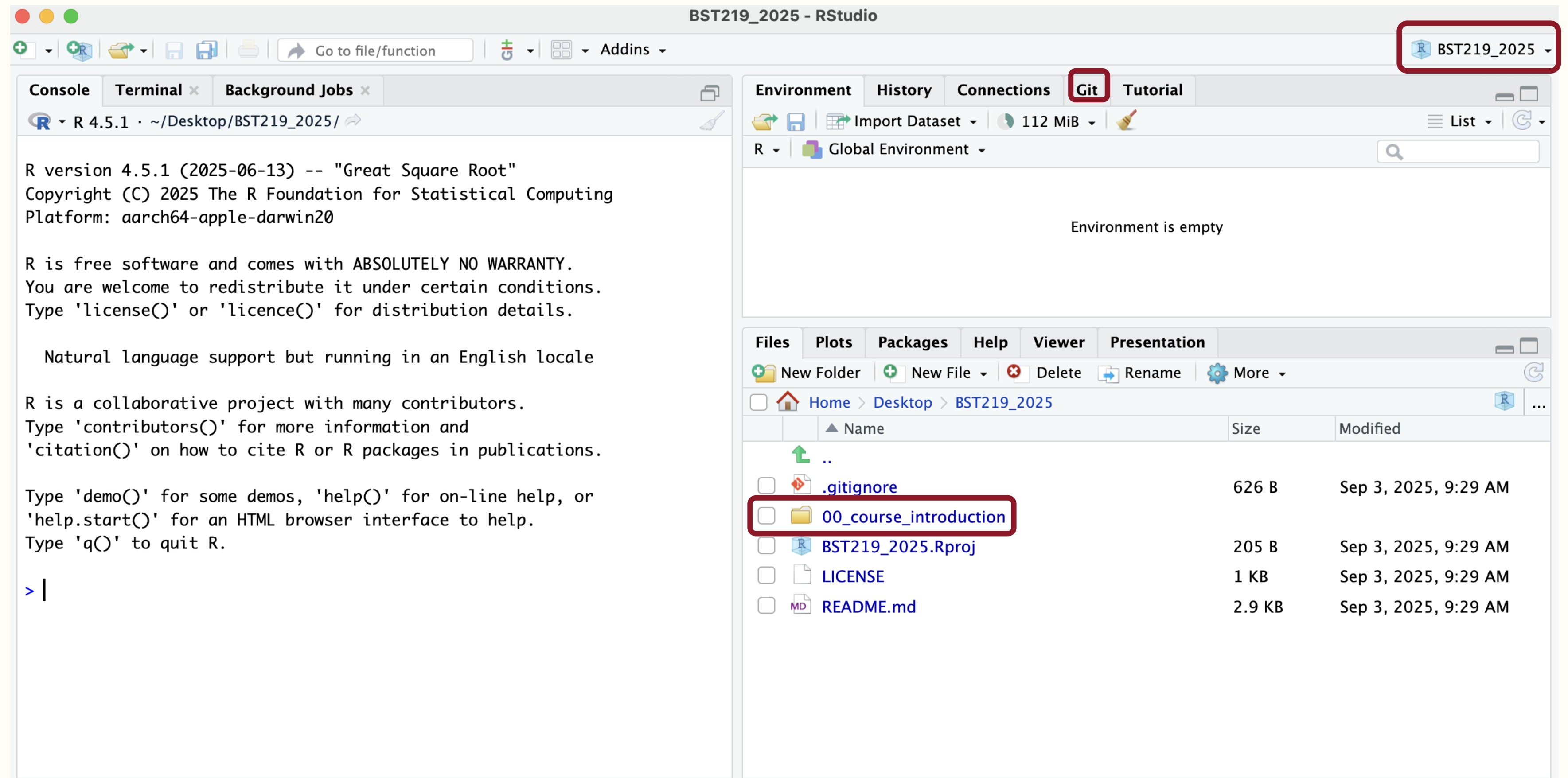
Project directory name:
BST219_2025

Create project as subdirectory of:
~/Desktop Browse...

☐ Open in new session Create Project Cancel

Accessing GitHub in RStudio

The project should open and you should see the project (repo) name and all folders and files in the repo.



Saving notes

To write notes/code directly into .Rmd files from the course repository, do the following:

1. Duplicate the file you want to add notes to.
2. Rename the copy of the file the same file name, but add **_personal** at the end.

	01-data-types.html	714.3 KB	Sep 11, 2025, 11:15 AM
	01-data-types.Rmd	8.8 KB	Sep 11, 2025, 11:19 AM
	02-vectors.html	620.5 KB	Sep 11, 2025, 10:53 AM
	02-vectors.Rmd	7.2 KB	Sep 11, 2025, 10:53 AM
	03-sorting_personal.Rmd	6.8 KB	Sep 16, 2025, 10:09 AM
	03-sorting.html	622.5 KB	Sep 16, 2025, 10:58 AM
	03-sorting.Rmd	6.8 KB	Sep 11, 2025, 10:53 AM

